

mechanism that needs to be in place to secure data. Predominantly, every solution focus has to be end-to-end. A lot of open ends are left where awareness is needed. Decision-makers of organisations have to look into the security aspect in depth.

Q. Is it better to have a third-party partner or an in-house team for security?

A. First, for any business, having an internal team for the IoT security is compulsory. To have that in place, there should be a recommended minimum. Going beyond that and having a third-party partner is undoubtedly a plus point since third-party vendors deal with the same kind of problems across organisations. This is especially helpful for those dealing with sensitive information. In those cases, having a third-party auditing or consultancy firm is truly beneficial.

Q. What is your main partner ecosystem at the moment?

A. This is how the chain works. First, sensors are installed and then comes gateway vendors. This enables data acquisitions. Starting from here till data analysis and visualisation, WebNMS comes in.

The other partnership model comes with system integrators. People who have customers that need IoT solutions can partner with us to deploy the complete solution. So, the complete partner ecosystem includes IoT hardware, OEMs and system integration partners.

Q. Is there clarity on use cases of different communication techs in the IoT, like LPWAN and NB-IOT?

A. Whenever we talk about IoT-enabled devices, it can be GSM or LoRa-based or something else. Here, adoption is important. But right now, there is no major clarity in this space. We all are experimenting with a lot of things, and are not sure if Sigfox or LoRa will win the game.

GSM is already popular. Then

there is NB-IOT coming into play. We need to look which infrastructure is going to be predominantly available for hardware vendors to latch onto. Adopting solutions is not a challenge. It is just a few modules coupled with some effort. Which technology is coming up and will stay is the main deciding factor.

Q. In which areas will IoT startups find better business opportunities?

A. There are two segments of IoT startups: B2C and B2B. In B2C segment, a lot is being experimented with, like home automation or wearables, healthcare and so on. In this segment, new products are always coming in and out and, hence, it is a very competitive market.

Newer startups can focus on B2B solutions or cases where there is a clear ROI. That is where it will be beneficial. Focus of IoT startups must be clear. You can also say that this is the major bottleneck in the startup ecosystem at present.

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GREEN TECH:

Building ENVIRONMENT-FRIENDLY SPACES

- A green building comprises green construction and a sustainable model. Green construction focuses on choice of materials used based on reduced carbon emission and improved air quality

Climate change is a global challenge, with excessively cold or hot weather conditions. Surface temperatures and sea levels are rising, monsoon patterns are changing and natural calamities are increasing. It is imperative to take active initiatives for protecting the environment. We can begin acting responsibly by building an environment-friendly house or workplace. For that, we need to focus on three major components, namely, energy efficiency, choice of materials and water efficiency.

A green building comprises green construction and a sustainable model. Green construction focuses on choice of

materials used based on reduced carbon emission and improved air quality. The sustainability model requires the building to be resource-efficient throughout its lifecycle. Surprisingly, the building sector has the potential of saving up to 50 per cent energy consumption worldwide. To achieve a worldwide goal to hold the global temperature increase at 2°C, it is important to convert all existing buildings into green ones, and make sure all new buildings are green.

Green buildings help reduce carbon emissions and achieve energy-efficient spaces without depleting non-renewable resources. Additionally, these help achieve low maintenance, healthier



Shanghai Tower, China, has been constructed from recycled plastic and employs passive temperature control strategies